

LOADZONE · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

LoadZone TRL 2 review decisions

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/loadzone		
Source	docs/decisions/0001-trl2-review-decisions.md @ 940f9c0		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Record the TRL 2 review recommendations adopted for TRL 3 work under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, and the items that remain open

0001: TRL 2 review decisions

- **Date:** 2026-09-25
- **Status:** proposed. The recommendations in items D1 to D8 are adopted for TRL 3 work pending Amish's review; item O1 and the new items O2 to O7 remain "Proposed, awaiting Amish".

■ Context

The TRL 2 review note (docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25, /populate) listed nine items as "Proposed, awaiting Amish". Eight carried a recommendation; the ninth (first trial partner and LoRaWAN band) did not. On 2026-09-25 Amish asked for this batch of Design Molecule repos to be taken through the usual process with the instruction "you know the drill, nothing gets past TRL 3". He has not reviewed this repo's items one by one. Every item that carried a recommendation is therefore adopted as recommended for TRL 3 work, open for his review. Items without a recommendation stay open. Nothing here is recorded as decided or approved by Amish.

■ Options considered

The options for each item are those listed in docs/REVIEW.md (session 2026-09-25, /populate) and in LDZ-PRC-001 v0.2, Key design choices. They are not repeated here.

■ Decision

Table 1. Items adopted for TRL 3 work.

#	Item	Adopted recommendation	Status
D1	Installation	Surface-bonded puck for pilots; a cored in-ground puck stays a later variant	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D2	Sensing	Magnetometer only for TRL 3; an upward radar stays an option if field data show R1 is missed	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D3	Granularity	One puck per vehicle slot of about 7 m, at the slot center 1.3 m from the curb face	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D4	Power	Two AA-size Li-SOCl ₂ primary cells	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D5	Housing	Rigid cast polyurethane dome, cavity fully potted in polyurethane, on a flat base	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D6	Sign option and budget	The sign stays a separate option outside the \$120 budget. <code>budget_usd</code> is unchanged; the budget is redefined to cover the two-puck bay kit only (R13)	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D7	Sign data path	LoRaWAN class C downlink from the network server to the sign's host FieldNode	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review
D8	Data format	Publish a feed that maps onto the Curb Data Specification Events and Metrics APIs, rather than implementing the specification directly	Adopted as recommended for TRL 3 under Amish's 2026-09-25 instruction, open for his review

No reworded pitch or problem line was recommended at TRL 2, so `project.yaml` and `README.md` keep the existing wording. No new `budget_usd` figure was recommended; the \$210 and \$340 alternatives in the TRL 2 note were options, not the recommendation, and are not applied.

Items that remain open

Table 2. Open items, "Proposed, awaiting Amish".

#	Item	Status
O1	First trial partner (a city curb team, a business district or a carrier) and the LoRaWAN band	Proposed, awaiting Amish. No preference stated at TRL 2. LDZ-CAL-001 uses EU868 figures
O2	R4 link from under a van. LDZ-CAL-001 gives about 350 m in a street canyon at SF9 with a 10 dB fade margin, not 1 km. Options: (a) restate R4 as a gateway within 300 m of the bay, in line of sight where possible; (b) keep 1 km and accept SF12, which breaks R3 and R5; (c) add a relay. Recommendation: (a)	Proposed, awaiting Amish. Not applied
O3	R6 bond under braking. The upper-bound bond shear (1.51 MPa) exceeds the assumed adhesive-to-asphalt strength. Options: (a) specify two-part road-marker epoxy rather than a bitumen pad; (b) restate R6 with the wheel-path finding that parked wheels straddle the puck; (c) both. Recommendation: (c), with a pull-off test at TRL 4	Proposed, awaiting Amish. Not applied
O4	R11 night legibility. The e-paper sign reads at about 28 m by day but is unlit; a 0.5 W front light needs 2.5 times FieldNode's 100 mW allowance. Options: (a) restate R11 as daylight only; (b) a lit display with its own power; (c) drop the sign in favor of the data feed. Recommendation: (a)	Proposed, awaiting Amish. Not applied
O5	Sign network. The class C sign takes about 200 downlinks a day, far above The Things Network's 10 a day. Recommendation: the sign option requires a private network server (TwinKit) or a city network that allows it; on The Things Network the sign would need LoRa point to point instead	Proposed, awaiting Amish
O6	Engineering proposals made at TRL 3: one Schottky diode per cell (parallel cells and the 3.6 V module limit), an 85 °C hybrid pulse capacitor, the fully potted cavity and a 6 mm crown radius	Engineering proposals, awaiting Amish's confirmation. Shown in the model and BOM
O7	Payload size. In US915 the slowest 125 kHz rate (SF10) carries at most 11 bytes; the 12-byte payload would not fit there. Recommendation: pack the payload into 11 bytes if the band chosen in O1 is US915	Proposed, awaiting Amish

■ Consequences

- LDZ-REQ-001, LDZ-PRC-001 and LDZ-PRB-001 move to v0.3: the design choices above are no longer "proposed" in the precis, R6 has a stated load basis, and R13 covers the two-puck kit only.
- The sign option (\$97 plus a host FieldNode at \$126.00) is costed in the BOM but outside the budget.
- R4 and R11 stay not met until O2 and O4 are decided; R6 stays at risk until O3 is decided.
- TRL 4 is on hold by Amish's instruction. Nothing in this record starts TRL 4 work.